

The Book of Enoch

1 Enoch

Angels, Judgment, and the Mysteries of Heaven — An Ancient Jewish Apocalyptic Text

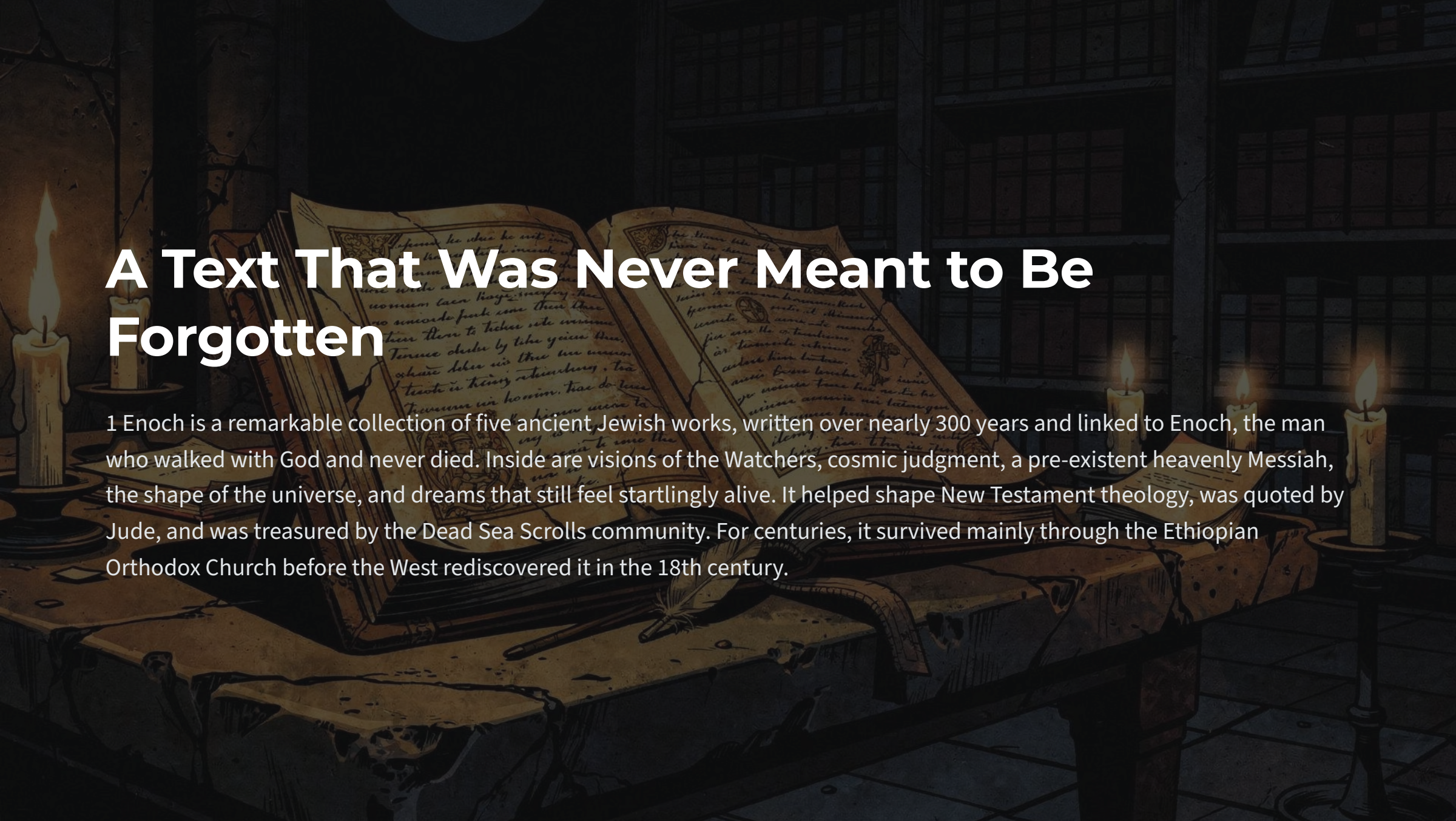
SECOND TEMPLE JUDAISM

APOCALYPTIC LITERATURE

PSEUDEPIGRAPHA

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A Text That Was Never Meant to Be Forgotten

1 Enoch is a remarkable collection of five ancient Jewish works, written over nearly 300 years and linked to Enoch, the man who walked with God and never died. Inside are visions of the Watchers, cosmic judgment, a pre-existent heavenly Messiah, the shape of the universe, and dreams that still feel startlingly alive. It helped shape New Testament theology, was quoted by Jude, and was treasured by the Dead Sea Scrolls community. For centuries, it survived mainly through the Ethiopian Orthodox Church before the West rediscovered it in the 18th century.



What Is the Book of Enoch?

The Book of Enoch, formally known as **1 Enoch**, is an apocalyptic collection of writings attributed to Enoch, the great-grandfather of Noah. In the Hebrew Bible, Enoch is described as a man who "walked with God, and he was not, for God took him" (Genesis 5:24). This tantalising verse made Enoch the only biblical figure besides Elijah said to have been taken directly to heaven without dying, and it became the seed from which an entire genre of Enochic literature grew.

Scholars universally agree that Enoch himself did not write the text. Rather, it is **pseudepigrapha**: a form of ancient literature in which a revered figure's name is adopted to lend authority to the work.

The text is not a single unified book but a **compilation of at least five originally separate documents** written by different authors across roughly three centuries, from approximately 300 BCE to the 1st century CE. What binds them together is a common apocalyptic literary style, a shared preoccupation with resisting the cultural corruption of Hellenism, and a fascination with Enoch as heaven's chosen witness and scribe.

At Its Core

1 Enoch is a work of **resistance literature**, designed to encourage faithful Jews suffering under Hellenistic cultural domination and political oppression during the Second Temple period (roughly 516 BCE to 70 CE).

Key Concerns

- The origin of evil and sin in the world
- Cosmic judgment and the vindication of the righteous
- A coming pre-existent heavenly Messiah
- Heavenly mysteries and the structure of the cosmos